



Ask Agent001

Q My PC configuration is as follows: Intel Core 2 Duo E4400 processor, Simmtronics 2 GB @667 MHz, Mercury 945G Express Chipset, Samsung 19-inch LCD TFT monitor. Please comment on the configuration and suggest a good / powerful DX10.0 graphics card below Rs. 10,000.

Harish Verma

Do away with the Simmtronics memory. Although it was good in the days of SD RAM, it is not any more. Besides, service will be an issue. Opt for 800 MHz DDR2 memory instead of 667 MHz memory; the price difference is negligible. For Rs. 10,000, I'd recommend either a GeForce 9800 GTX+ or a Radeon HD 4850-based graphics card.

Q I'm planning to buy a laptop in the next six months with a budget of Rs. 60,000. I'm looking for something that's suitable for audio, video, gaming and office use. Please suggest a good configuration with good build quality, battery, features, support and services.

Rupak Nirola

If you want a multimedia notebook for that price, I recommend the Dell XPS 1530. It's a solid performer for its price and comes with a very good processor. Dell also allows customisation of the components, so you can end up with exactly what you like.

Q I want to buy a digital camera in the price range of Rs. 7,000 to 10,000. I want it primarily for capturing photos indoors (with less bright light than sunlight).

I have decided on a Samsung i8. Have I made the right choice? Please tell me about the best cameras in the range.

Amit Singh

Indoor shooting is indeed a problem for most point-and-shoot cameras. Instead of the Samsung i8, I'd look at either the Canon SX100 IS or the A720 IS. Both these models feature 8-MP sensors and work well with higher ISO settings.

Q My friend has the following configuration - an Abit IP35-E motherboard, 2 GB of Corsair memory, an XFX GeForce 9400GT, WD 250 GB hard drive. He is in a dilemma as to which processor to buy. He also needs suggestions for the power supply. Please help.

Chirag S

Here, he needs to figure out his budget and also his usage patterns. Does he game or do video editing? On a budget of Rs. 10,000 or so, I'd recommend the Core 2 Duo E8500 (3.16 GHz) for gaming. For a budget of Rs. 8,000, I recommend the E8400 (3.0 GHz). For multi-tasking and rendering, I recommend a quad core. His options are the Core 2 Duo Q6600 (2.4 GHz) at Rs. 10,000. If he is willing to spend a little more, he can go for the Q9450 (2.66 GHz) at Rs. 12,500, which is a superb all-round performer. For the power supply, look at Corsair's VX 450 for Rs. 4,000. It's a superb PSU.

Q I am a huge gaming fan, but I feel that my graphics card is out-dated. I have a dual-core processor with 2GB of RAM. I'm currently using the NVIDIA

GeForce 6200 LE. I've heard great things about the 9800 GTX+. I want a card dedicated to gaming only if it is powerful and allows me to play games like *Crysis* and *Crysis Warhead* at maximum settings and will also be future proof.

Vinayak Goyal

First, you have not mentioned the rest of your system configuration and your exact CPU. Second, you have not mentioned a specific budget. The 9800GTX+ is indeed a good card and can be had for as little as Rs. 11,000 these days. But this card will only be future proof for the next six months or so, since games like *Crysis* will spawn better-looking, resource-heavy variants. I recommend the GTX 260, which you can have for Rs. 19,000. Also, look for the ATI Radeon HD 4870 1 GB. At Rs. 18,500 or so, this card is great value for money. For NVIDIA GPUs, look at brands such as XFX, ASUS, ZOTAC, EVGA and Gigabyte. For ATI GPUs, look at Sapphire and Palit.

Q I want to buy an LCD TV and a 5.1 music system, both under Rs. 1,00,000. I want at least a 32-inch screen size with good viewing angles and good contrast ratio for the TV. The speakers should be powerful and suitable for a large sized room.

Kshitij Rawat

For the television, I recommend Samsung's Bordeaux 32-inch range of flat panels. LG's Scarlet series is also good. Both should be priced at around the Rs. 45,000 mark. In fact, we've done a comparison test each for large screen panels and home theatre systems in this very issue, so check that out as well.

Q I want to buy a laptop. The main requirements are that it should have at least a 14-inch screen, 15 inches is preferable and should be future proof. I plan to use it for moderate gaming and would prefer that it runs the latest games, but have no qualms about running the games at low settings. Therefore, I would prefer a dedicated GPU from ATI or NVIDIA. I don't really care for things like fingerprint readers and web cams, but would love to have good-quality speakers, at least a 250GB HDD and options like TV out and HDMI.

Amlan Mathur

There is a difference between 14.1-inch and 15.4-inch notebooks in terms of portability and pricing. From your query, I gather you do not want something compact. You have also not mentioned a budget for the same. For gaming, you will need a discrete graphics solution. Dell's Studio XPS 16 is a good option for you. It is available with a GeForce 9500 LE graphics solution and priced at Rs. 68,000 makes a sensible buy for the discerning gamer. It also has TV-out and HDMI connects. If you really want to go crazy and get a really powerful solution, opt for the new Macbook Pro. At 15.4-inches and with the option of a mighty GeForce 9600 GT video solution, this notebook is definitely for the hardcore gamer. You can install Windows XP using Bootcamp and have it co-exist peacefully with Mac OS-X. This notebook is a beauty, but is priced accordingly too! Expect to pay Rs. 1,30,000 for the upgraded version, which has 4 GB of DDR3 memory, 2.53 GHz processor and GeForce 9600GT graphics solution with a 250 GB hard drive.



Ask Away

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